



AssetMark Leadership Advantage

Advisor Onboarding

Your firm has enrolled in AssetMark's Leadership Advantage program.

The first step in our engagement is the onboarding process and completing these materials.



Getting Started Checklist



Value Maximization Index



Onboarding Questionnaire

Getting Started Checklist

The Business Assessment Tool provides you with a view of your business performance - allowing you to benchmark your firm, calculate key performance metrics and provide ongoing comparisons against your goals and key performance indicators. By creating a clear picture of the drivers that increase or decrease practice value, you can build a better and more valuable business.

The worksheet below will help you assemble the information you need to get started on the Business Assessment Tool.

Indicate the time period for your financial data (e.g., "Jan. - June 2019"):

☐ Full year ☐ YTD current year Month for YTD entry: _____

Total Firm Assets Under Management

\$ _____

The entire market value of each securities portfolio for which you provide continuous and regular supervisory or management services.

Non-Recurring Revenue

\$ _____

One-time or specifically time-bound revenue that will not generate continuously because it is based on the sale of a single product or the administration of a one-time fee. These typically include: up-front / first year commissions on products (e.g., insurance, variable annuities, REITs, etc), consulting fees or hourly project fees (e.g., up front financial planning fees, etc.).

Recurring Revenue

\$ _____

Predictable, stable revenue that will generate continuously into the future with a high degree of certainty, so long as a client remains with the business or holds a specific project. Typically these include: Asset management fees, flat / retainer fees charged on an ongoing basis, trails (i.e., mutual fund / 12-b1 fees, variable annuity trails, etc.).

Direct Expenses

\$ _____

Expenses that are directly related to revenue generating activities or professionals.

These typically include: normalized salaries, commissions, bonuses, benefits and payroll costs for owner advisors (not including ownership or profit distributions), non-owner advisors or business development officers, and all forms of compensation paid as part of referral or solicitor relationships.

Indirect Expenses

\$ _____

Expenses that are not directly related to revenue generating activities or professionals.

These expenses typically relate to operating expenses, such as non-advisor staffing compensation, rent, technology, insurance and marketing.

Projected Annual Growth Rate

%

The anticipated or average annual growth rate of the firm in the near-term, typically 3-5 years.

Number of Client Relationships

Total number of client relationships or households served by the firm.

Number of New Clients

The number of new client relationships during the time period.

Number of FTE Advisors

The full-time equivalent number of owners or non-owner advisors directly responsible for managing client relationships and/or delivering advice.

Number of FTE Non-Advisors

The full-time equivalent number of team members who work in a support role that specifically is non-revenue generating and is not responsible for managing client relationships. An FTE of "1" would be equivalent to one (1) full-time staff person, while an FTE of less than 1 (e.g., "0.5") would be the equivalent of a staff person who works 20 hours per week. An FTE of "1.5" could be equivalent to 1 full-time staff + 1 part-time staff, or 3 part-time staff persons.

Value Maximization Index



The Value Maximization Index (VMI) assesses your firm's relative business risk, transferability, sustainability and potential growth.

Value Maximization Index™

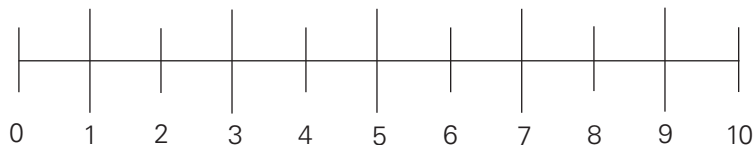
The **Value Maximization Index™** (VMI) assesses your firm's relative business risk, transferability, sustainability and potential growth. Your VMI is calculated based upon your responses to each value maximization indicator question, providing a total score in four key practice management areas.

Rate your business on the scale from 0 to 10 for each question. For example, if you feel you are 70% of the way to completing a clearly-defined business plan, select "7" on the rating scale.

Multiply your points total by 5, for a maximum score of 250 per section.

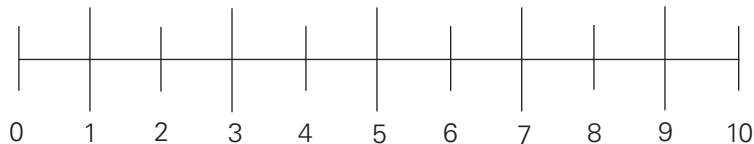
BUSINESS STRATEGY & PLANNING

I do not have a written business plan that drives future (1-,3-,5+-year) goals.



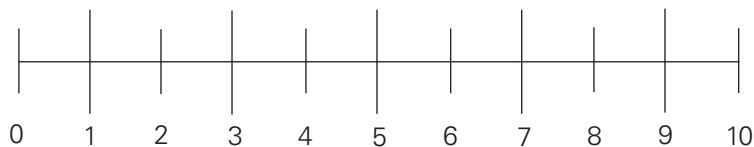
I have a written business plan that is executed consistently and drives future goals.

I do not track financial business metrics.



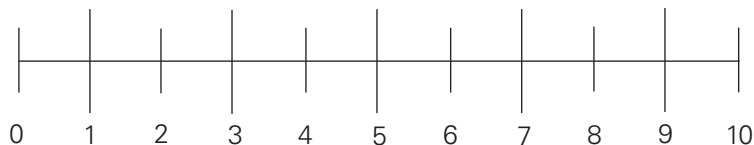
I regularly track financial business metrics and work towards goals based on those metrics.

All of my clients are in the distribution phase of their financial lives.



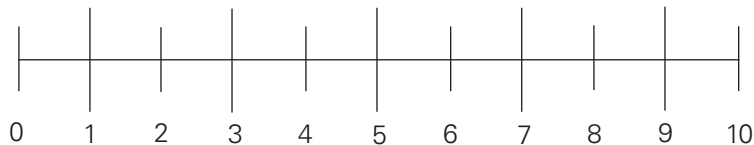
All of my clients are in the accumulation stage of their financial lives.

All of my revenue is commission-based.



All of my revenue is recurring and fee-based.

I have an advisor-driven practice that is solely reliant upon me.

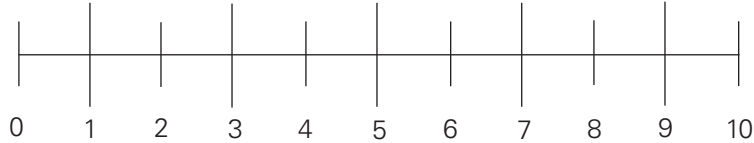


I have a process-driven, sustainable practice that I can easily transition.

Subtotal: _____ **out of 250**

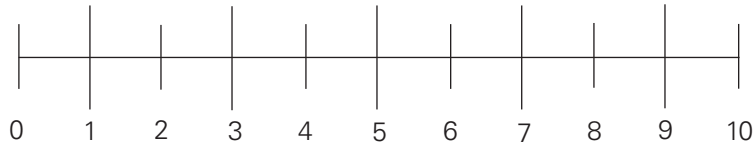
MARKETING YOUR BUSINESS

I do not have a clearly defined value proposition.



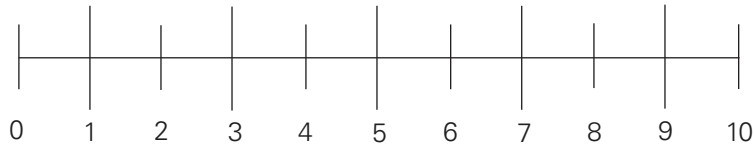
I have a clearly defined value proposition that is aligned with my target market.

I do not have formal marketing materials, a web site or an institutionalized brand.



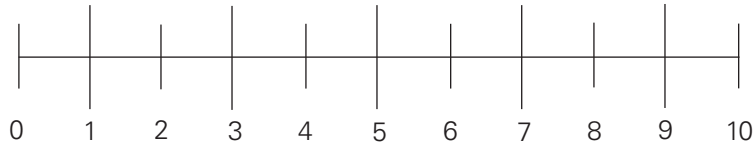
I have high-quality marketing materials, including a website, with an institutionalized brand.

I do not have a formal marketing plan and do not have a consistent flow of prospects.



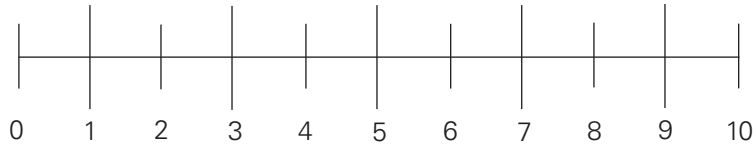
I have a formal marketing plan that consistently drives high quality prospects to my practice.

I have difficulty evaluating prospects because I have not defined my ideal client.



I consistently assess prospects using my ideal client profile that aligns with my target market.

I rarely get new business from client, center of influence or professional referrals.

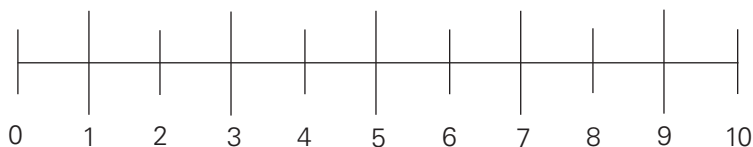


I consistently get new business from client, center of influence and professional referrals.

Subtotal: _____ out of 250

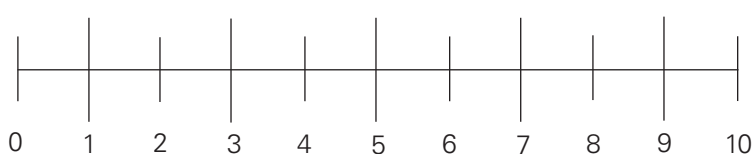
CLIENT EXPERIENCE & OPERATIONS

I do not automate processes with technological or outsourced solutions.



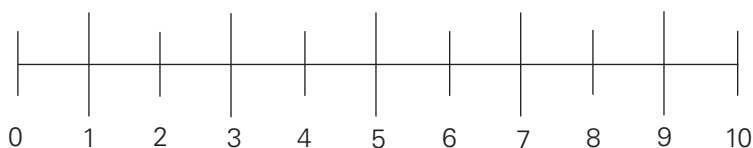
I consistently automate processes, utilizing technological and outsourced solutions.

I do not have written procedures for my operations and perform tasks using ad hoc processes.



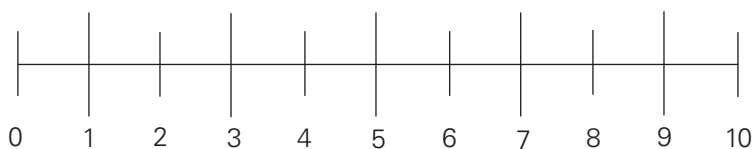
I have detailed written procedures for my business operations that are performed consistently.

I have not segmented my client base so I do not know how different clients drive revenue.



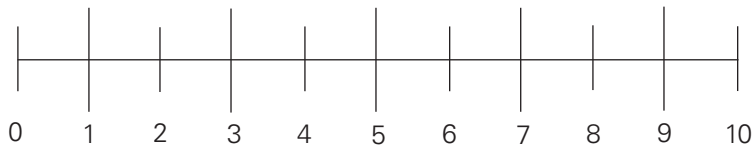
I have segmented my client base into tiers and know how they impact revenue and profitability.

I do not have a defined client service model and frequently provide non-standardized services.



I have a defined client service model that consistently provides a high-quality client experience.

I do not have a formal or consistent fee schedule.

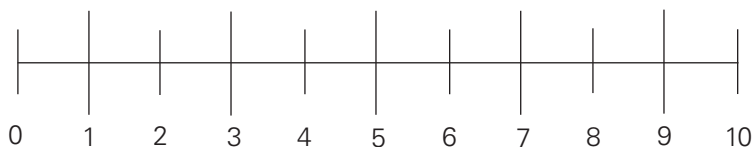


I have a formal fee schedule that is applied consistently and aligned with the services provided.

Subtotal: _____ **out of 250**

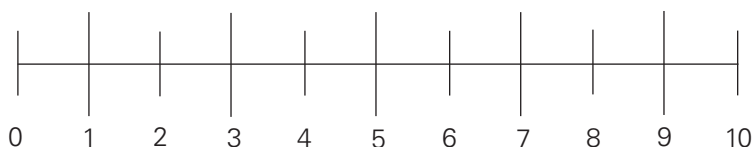
EMPOWERING YOUR TEAM

I have not invested resources in human capital development.



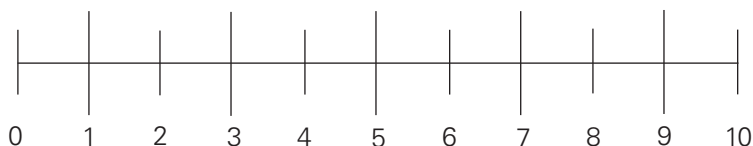
I have invested in developing and growing a staff in line with my firm's strategy and goals.

I do not have a formal compensation plan that aligns with industry standards.



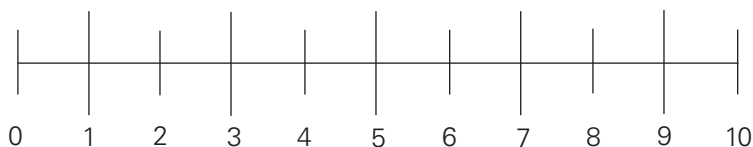
I have a formal compensation plan, aligned with industry standards that motivates my team.

I am responsible for all aspects of client engagement, service and back-office operations.



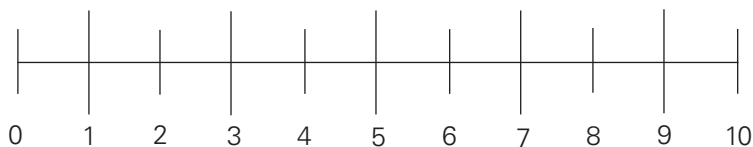
I focus only on revenue-producing activities and outsource or use my staff for everything else.

I am not staffed adequately to effectively manage my workload or reach my growth objectives.



I am staffed optimally to effectively manage my work load and I have capacity for growth.

I have problems with employee retention or have no employees to retain.



I have no problems with employee retention and have staff that are in the business for the long term.

Subtotal: _____ **out of 250**

Business Strategy & Planning

Empowering your Team

Client Experience & Operations

Marketing Your Business

Grand Total: _____ **out of 1000**

Onboarding Process Introduction



The goal of the onboarding process is to gain an understanding of your individual firm, its current situation and team, and to identify strengths and opportunities for ongoing business improvements that will build a stronger, more effective organization.



We want you to be comfortable sharing information. As such, your individual questionnaire is not shared with anyone.

We appreciate and value the time and effort you've extended in providing information and input. We look forward to working with you to bring about meaningful improvements in your business.

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Please return this document to: Melissa.Intezar@AssetMark.com

NOTE: This document is a fillable PDF.

Please type your answers in the highlighted text fields.

General Information

Name	
Title	
Credentials / Degrees	
Direct email	
What year was your firm started, and how long have you been with the Producer Group?	
Briefly describe the key duties of your position.	

Your Position

Please describe your workload.	☐ Slow – there is always more time than needed to complete work ☐ Well-paced – everything can be completed on an even pace ☐ Sporadic – certain periods are excessive, others are slow ☐ Excessive – there is a more work to complete than the time available
How satisfied are you with your workload?	☐ Dissatisfied ☐ Neutral ☐ Very Satisfied ☐ Extremely satisfied
List 3 things that would help you perform your job more successfully:	
What do you enjoy most about your position?	
What do you enjoy least about your position?	

Position Compensation

Prior year total <i>income</i> <i>(Salary, Distributions, Profit, etc.)</i>	\$ Goal: \$
Describe your compensation structure	☐ Profit Distribution ☐ Salary ☐ Salary + Profit ☐ Distributions ☐ Other:
Which of the following benefits do you have available through your business?	☐ Health ☐ Dental ☐ Vision ☐ Retirement Contribution ☐ Other:

Your Firm

How would you describe your practice model?	☐ Solo ☐ Silo ☐ Ensemble Comments:
How would you describe your service model?	☐ Money/Investment Manager ☐ Wealth Manager ☐ Investment Planner ☐ Financial Planner Other/Comments:
Who is your current Custodian	
How would you describe what your firm “does” in 20 words or less?	
How would you describe the firm’s ability to implement change?	☐ Poor ☐ Average ☐ Excellent Comments:
In your opinion, what is working well in the firm?	
In your opinion, what is not working well?	
How responsive is / are your staff to work requests?	☐ Poor ☐ Average ☐ Excellent Comments:

History & Goals

For the clients you directly manage, please answer the following:	Prior Year	Current YTD	Current Year Goal
Number of clients (households)			
Total assets	\$	\$	\$
Fee-based AUM	\$	\$	\$
Total revenue	\$	\$	\$
Expenses (if applicable)	\$	\$	\$
Net income / profit	\$	\$	\$
% of non-recurring revenue	%	%	%
% of recurring revenue	%	%	%
Number of staff that directly support you			

Technology

CRM (Client Relationship Management)	☐ Redtail ☐ Junxure ☐ Salesforce ☐ Outlook ☐ ACT ☐ Other: ☐ I do not use a CRM system
Financial Planning	☐ MoneyGuide Pro ☐ eMoney ☐ Money Tree ☐ NaviPlan ☐ Finance Logix ☐ Other:
Account Aggregation	☐ Albridge ☐ eMoney ☐ ByAllAccounts ☐ CashEdge ☐ Other: ☐ I do not use aggregation software
Business Financials	☐ QuickBooks ☐ Quicken ☐ PeachTree ☐ Other: ☐ I do not use a software system for financials

Thank you for taking the time and giving careful thought to the answers and information provided. Please forward any questions to Melissa.Intezar@AssetMark.com.

IMPORTANT INFORMATION

This is for informational purposes only, is not a solicitation, and should not be considered investment or tax advice. This information has been drawn from sources believed to be reliable, but its accuracy is not guaranteed, and is subject to change.

Investing involves risk, including the possible loss of principal. Past performance does not guarantee future results.

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